Contradiction Memo

Date: October 19, 2026 | **Team:** Team 3 | **Author:** Juan Reyna

Original assumption: Our charter assumed lack of motivation is a main reason people struggle with recreational activities, and that social support, accountability, and rewards would keep users engaged. Because of this, our scope included sharable progression cards, an activity feed, leaderboards, and certificates.

What was found: Participants were already motivated. In INT-01, the participant does activities for fun, love, skill, and protection, "not for fame/awards," and small setbacks don't demotivate them. They also avoid sharing their progress because they don't like the pressure, even though they would like to overcome that. What actually stopped participants was time. INT-01 hadn't done much since last month because of school, and in INT-03 work got in the way of going back to boxing, and time was the main reason they hadn't started golf lessons.

What it means: Tracking is still valuable. INT-02 finds it difficult to know if they are improving and would like quantitative statistics or reinforcement from others, but spends no time reviewing or documenting their progress. INT-03 already uses golf apps to track stats and compares swing form with past videos. The problem is not a lack of motivation but a lack of time, and SkillUp's planned features rely on users spending extra time logging and sharing, which busy users are unlikely to do.

What changes: SkillUp should make tracking quick and private by default, such as adding a recording already on the user's phone instead of filling out long logs. Sharing, leaderboards, and certificates should be optional, not the main reason to use the app. Going forward, we should test whether users return to SkillUp when tracking takes less time, rather than assuming social features and rewards will keep them engaged.